

MARKING REQUIREMENTS OF PRODUCTS

Markings too are part of safe design. So go beyond the minimum. Guidelines follow



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Electronic products are designed for shock protection, thermal and fire insulation, etc. Providing the related markings on the products, however, is equally important. Markings not only provide instructions about the use of the product but also caution the users against possible injuries, health hazards, or damage to the property and environment from wrong operation, installation and process of the equipment.

National and international standards make marking mandatory on the exterior of products. It can be in the form of a name plate, warning or caution. A product may have additional markings too. Some of the essential markings other than warning markings are identification markings and power rating markings. Also, depending upon the type of the product, there could be some specific markings, like

those related to laser radiation and disposal instructions. Additional markings are permitted, provided they do not lead to any misunderstanding.

Identification markings

An apparatus should be marked with:

1. Name, trademark or identification mark of the maker or responsible vendor
2. Model number or type reference, name or other means to identify the equipment. If equipment bearing

the same distinctive designation (model number) are manufactured at more than one location, equipment from each manufacturing location should be marked such that the location can be identified.

3. Symbol of class II—□ (IEC 60417-5172)—if applicable

Identification markings should be readily visible to the operator and should not be located on the bottom for those equipment which weigh more than 18 kg. For stationary equipment, identification markings should be visible after the equipment is installed for normal use.

Power ratings marking

The purpose of a power rating marking is to specify the mains supply of correct voltage and frequency, and adequate current rating capacity.

The marking should include:

1. Rated voltages or rated voltage ranges in volts. The voltage range should have a hyphen (-) between the minimum and maximum voltages. For example, the rated voltage range of 220-240V means the equipment is designed to connect to an AC mains supply having a voltage between 220V and 240V. When multiple rated voltages or

Table I
Marking Requirements for Different Product Categories

Product category	Examples	Marking standard
IT equipment	ATMs, PCs and telephone sets	IEC 60950/IS 13252
Household appliances	Washing machines and OTGs	IEC 60335/IS 302
Audio-video products	Electronic musical instruments, video games, audio and video educational apparatus	IEC 60065/IS 616
Laboratory and control equipment	Power supplies, IVD equipment, sample handling equipment	IEC 61010